GERUNDS AND INFINITIVES

B2 Cheat Sheet

1 INFINITIVES

1. To express purpose

- I'm studying hard **to pass** my exams.
- She saved some money **to buy** a new laptop.
- They left early **to avoid** the traffic.
- He called his lawyer **to ask** for advice.
- We went to Madrid **to visit** the Prado Museum.
- I turned down the music **to concentrate.**
- We installed a security system **to protect** our home.

2. Adjective + infinitive

- I'm glad **to see** you.
- It's important **to plan** ahead.
- She was **lucky to win** the prize.
- He's easy **to talk to.**
- It was kind of you **to help** me.
- We're disappointed **to hear** the news.
- It's essential **to drink** enough water.
- I was surprised **to find** you here.
- They were excited **to travel** abroad.
- He's too tired **to go** out tonight.

3. Some verbs + infinitive
(no change in meaning)

- **want** — I want **to** improve my English.
- **need** — You need **to** rest more.
- **would like** — I'd like **to speak** to you.
- **forget** — Don't forget **to** lock the door.
- **decide** — I decided **to** accept the offer.
- **pretend** (fingir) — He pretended to be interested.
- **remember** — Remember to email me.
- **promise** — I promise **to** call you later.
- **refuse** — She refused **to** answer.
- **expect + object** — I expect you to arrive on time.
- **seem** (parece) — He seems **to** be happy.
- **arrange** — I arranged **to** meet her on Friday.

2 GERUNDS -ING

1. Verb as a subject

- **Travelling** broadens the mind.
- **Reading** widely improves your vocabulary.
- **Swimming** every morning keeps you fit.
- **Learning** from mistakes is essential.
- **Patience** is a virtue.
- **Time management** is crucial in today's world.
- **Being** honest builds trust.
- **Overthinking** can lead to stress.
- **Taking** risks is sometimes necessary.
- **Making** good decisions is not always easy.

2. Preposition + gerund

- I'm interested **in learning** Spanish.
- She's skilled **at solving** problems.
- We're **used to waking** up early.
- He's tired **of hearing** the same excuses.
- I'm looking **forward to seeing** you.
- I'm terrified **of flying.**
- I'm proud **of what** you've achieved.
- He's responsible **for managing** the team.
- They're accused **of cheating.**
- I'm aware **of the risks** involved.
- We're capable **of achieving** more.
- She insisted **on paying** the bill.

3. Some verbs + gerund

- **enjoy** — I enjoy **playing** the piano.
- **don't mind** (no importa) — I don't mind **waiting.**
- **keep + gerund = continue** — He kept **talking** during the class.
- **feel like** (apetecer) — I feel like **going** for a run.
- **can't stand** (no soportar) — I can't stand **listening** to that song.
- **look forward to** — We're looking forward to **hearing** from you.
- **have trouble** — She has trouble concentrating.
- **spend time / waste time** — He spends too much time on social media.
- **be worth** — It's worth trying.
- **finish** — I finished **reading** the book.
- **practise** — She practises yoga every day.

3 VERBS THAT TAKE BOTH

Same meaning

begin — It began to rain. = It began raining.
start — He started to study. = He started studying.
continue — She continued to work. = She continued working.
try — I tried to fix it. = I tried fixing it.
prefer — I prefer to read. = I prefer reading.
like — I like to cook. = I like cooking.
hate — I hate to wait. = I hate waiting.
love — I love to travel. = I love travelling.
plan — I plan to visit Rome. = I plan visiting Rome.
intend — I intend to apply. = I intend applying.

Different meaning

Stop

1. I stopped to help the old man. (I stopped in order to help him.)
2. I stopped smoking. (I quit smoking.)
3. He stopped to think. (He paused in order to think.)
4. He stopped thinking about the problem. (He no longer thinks about it.)

Remember

1. Remember to send the email. (Don't forget to send it.)
2. I remember sending the email yesterday. (I have a memory of doing it.)
3. Remember to bring your ID. (Don't forget.)
4. I remember meeting him at the conference. (I have a memory of it.)

4 NEGATIVE FORMS

When the infinitive or gerund is negative, use 'not' before the infinitive or gerund.

- She promised **not to** insult me again! But she did it anyway!
- I don't like **not knowing** the answer. — He avoided answering the question.
- I'm looking forward **not to having** any meetings tomorrow.
- He refused **not to** apologise.
- I regret **not applying** for the scholarship.
- They remembered **not to forget** their passports.